



CLEAN GLOBAL ELECTRICITY. FEASIBLE OR A PIPE DREAM?

“With the power sector counting for a quarter of global emissions, the clean energy transition is central to tackling climate change” – COP26 President Alok Sharma

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Electricity is an indispensable part of human lives. It has been 270 years. Right since Benjamin Franklin famously used a kite and key on a rainy day, electricity has slowly garnered importance through the likes of Michael Faraday and George Ohm. We often tend to take electricity as a thing that is just there in our lives. However, the generation of

electricity to power the entire globe has a cost attached to it.

The cost of electricity is essentially human lives if we look at it in a way. The planet is heating up, and climate change is real. Polar ice caps are melting, the number of forest fires is increasing, and more species are becoming extinct due to the ecological changes humans have brought about. More than 40 percent of energy

related CO² emissions are due to the burning of fossil fuels for the generation of electricity. The electricity sector was the highest greenhouse gas emitting sector in 2020. Fossil fuels have long sustained life, but they often have been termed as dirty energy, and rightly so given the damage their use causes. Global events like the Conference of the Parties (COP) are being held to set targets to replace this dirty energy and replace the same with renewable energy.

Renewable energy, also known as clean energy can help cut down on greenhouse gas emissions. Cutting down the carbon emissions would mean a positive step towards a sustainable future. However, the big question is, whether we are armed enough for the future we want.

RISE OF THE RENEWABLES

Earth is full of resources that be sustainable energy sources. Wind, Sun, and water are some of the sources that are in a way continuously replenished. The use of such resources to produce energy for our daily consumption is the cleaner future humans are targeting. Renewable energy sources can replace the traditional methods of energy production that cater to all sectors of the ever-evolving world. The shift of focus from fossil fuels to dependability on the Sun, wind and water can help cut down on emissions. Wind and solar energy are cheaper than coal in some countries and will prove to be the main allies in building an emission-free future.

The cost effectiveness of renewable energy is also a major factor in determining how fast and how successfully countries can progress towards net zero emissions. Political, financial, and technical leaders of the worlds have joined hands to ensure renewable sources of energy become an attractive option for power generation.

The silver lining to an rather dark cloud of our environment's health is that the capacity to generate electricity through renewable energy is gradually accelerating. With the policies in place and monitoring of emissions, renewable forms are at an all-time high. These numbers are set to get